

ROCKY GRAY

Software Engineering Leader

 Washington D.C. Metro Area

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EXPERIENCE

Chief Technology Officer (Fractional)

Onyx Rose Advisors

 Oct 2025 — Present

 Remote

- Lead all technical strategy and product development for a health policy and technology advisory firm serving government, managed care, and life sciences clients.
- Built **PolicySight.io** — an AI-powered platform that transforms complex policy regulations and state-level implementation details into actionable insights, designed on a **RAG architecture** (pgvector + OpenAI) on AWS.
- Equity Quotient engagement:* Architected an end-to-end **public health data pipeline** ingesting CDC Wonder and U.S. Census ACS data into Snowflake; built a custom **YAML-driven CDC Wonder client** in Go with automatic chunking, retry logic, and concurrent batch execution; integrated **dbt** for consistent data modeling, lineage tracking, and analytical layer separation.

Go

Python

AWS

RAG

pgvector

OpenAI

Snowflake

dbt

Leadership

Engineering Manager

Reddit

 Dec 2024 — Oct 2025

 Remote — San Francisco, CA

- Led the **Ads API Platform** and **Business Engineering** teams, driving partner integrations, platform reliability, and cross-functional delivery to unlock new revenue opportunities.
- Rate Limit Redesign:** Coordinated Reddit's first private beta launch for a platform project by aligning with external partners and 20+ internal teams to define and implement upstream system policies.
- MCP Server Implementation:** Guided the team that built the first MCP server in the Ads organization, which earned top recognition at Reddit's company-wide hackathon. Established myself as a subject matter expert (SME) in MCP design and implementation.

Leadership

API Platform

Data Engineering

Go

Python

OpenAPI

Engineering Manager

Cash App

 Feb 2023 — Aug 2024

 Remote — San Francisco, CA

- Accountable for the **real-time distributed ledger** that tracks all financial transactions within the Cash App ecosystem.
- Directed teams across **core infrastructure for money movement**, balancing reliability with innovation.
- Mentored engineers and established strong **system design practices**, helping scale the platform for growth and resilience.

Leadership

API Platform

Data Engineering

Java

Engineering Manager

Twitter

 Nov 2020 — Nov 2022

 Remote — San Francisco, CA

- Scaled global Ads API Data Service** teams from 5 to 15 engineers, creating two specialized groups.
- Promoted multiple engineers (ICs to Staff and one to EM), demonstrating strong people development and leadership.
- Defined a **multi-year roadmap** to improve API development velocity and cross-functional delivery.
- Drove adoption of an **architectural pattern** enabling parallel product experimentation, accelerating both ads and API innovation.

Leadership

API Platform

Data Engineering

Scala

Java

GraphQL

OpenAPI

Senior Software Engineering Manager

Capital One

 Apr 2018 — Oct 2020

 McLean, VA

- Tech lead and people leader for the Focus platform, enabling secure, scalable document storage and third-party integrations.
- Delivered **dual-region architecture, asynchronous virus scanning, and object-level encryption** to strengthen resiliency.
- Won a **Technical Excellence Award** for innovation, reliability, and platform growth.
- Co-inventor on multiple patents derived from platform designs.

NodeJS

Go

Java

Kubernetes

Aurora MySQL

Cassandra

Terraform

CloudFormation

Ansible

AWS

API Platform

OpenAPI

Data Engineering

Leadership

Lead Software Engineer

Storyblocks

 Dec 2014 — Mar 2018

 Arlington, VA

LIFE PHILOSOPHY

“Never give up.”

STRENGTHS

- **System Design & Architecture**
Large-scale distributed systems, platform design
- **Leadership**
Building, mentoring, and scaling high-performing teams
- **Platforms & APIs**
Ads APIs, ledgers, financial systems, enterprise integrations
- **Execution**
Driving cross-functional alignment, delivering impact

EDUCATION

B.E. in Computer Engineering
Vanderbilt University

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Solutions Architect Associate**
Jan 2019: EET55E012B1QQC5L
- **Certified Secure Software Engineer Associate**
March 2020

PATENTS

- **US Patent US10474506B1**
“Finite state machine driven workflows,” Nov. 12 2019
- **US Patent US10997611B2**
“Distribution of media with tracking and analysis of media usage for royalty, loyalty and collection of metadata,” May 4 2021
- **US Patent US11171945B2**
“Time-based token trust depreciation,” Nov. 9 2021
- **US Patent US11113678B2**
“Systems configured to manage user-related external party-activity software objects by using machine-readable indicia and methods of use thereof,” Sept. 7 2021

- Tech lead of Strategic Technologies team, providing **platforms, cloud infrastructure, data pipelines, and enterprise APIs**.
- Led AWS migration, event-driven KPI pipeline, and established enterprise APIs that generated \$1M+ new revenue.
- Advocated for engineers, provided mentorship, and supported organizational growth.

PHPNodeJSScalaReactAngularPythonRuby

DockerMySQLPostgresMongoDBCloudFormation

AnsibleData EngineeringAPI PlatformOpenAPIAWS

Leadership

Software Engineer

Capital One

📅 Jul 2012 — Dec 2014📍 Vienna, VA

- Built first **REST APIs for credit card resources** and co-developed the **API Developer Portal**—banking’s first public APIs.

APIJavaOpenAPIData Engineering